Outreach: The Four Messages, In Order

Nobody is ignoring you because your resume is thin. They are ignoring you because the message gave them nothing to reply to. Four messages, each with exactly one job, run in order. Only the fourth one compounds.

THE SEQUENCE, IN ONE PARAGRAPH

A connection request is not networking, and neither is a fifteen-minute call. The sequence is: get accepted, get the call, ask the questions nobody asks, then send the note that turns one contact into two. Most people run message one, skip to nothing, and call it outreach. The whole loop costs ninety seconds a person. Five a week, from your school address, asking for time and not a job. That is twelve weeks of runway, or zero.

The Sequence

Message	When it goes out	What actually has to be true
1 · The Connection Note	**Day one, 300 characters**	Year, school, major, what you are focused on. Then one line of real detail: their group, their school, a deal team, and why it lines up with where you are going. Close with connect and follow your work. **No ask.** This note exists to get accepted, nothing more.
2 · The Ask	**Three to five days after they accept**	You are a [year] at [School] recruiting for [Division] summer analyst roles, you have researched the group, and you want specifics beyond the website. One real reason their background stood out, twelve words maximum. Then: fifteen minutes in the next couple weeks, early morning or after close, around their calendar.
3 · The Fifteen Minutes	**When they say yes**	Five questions, in order, and you do not pitch yourself once. Their Tuesday hour by hour. The first-90-days surprise. What separates the analysts who get the return offer. The skill they wish they had built. Then who else you should be talking to. That last one is the whole point of the call.
4 · The Follow-Up	**Within 24 hours**	Name the specific thing they said and what it changed in how you are approaching this. Name the concrete action you are taking on their advice, and say you will report back. Then ask for the intro they already floated, with no pressure either way. This is the message that turns one call into three.

The Fifteen Minutes

Ask this	What it actually buys you
“What does your Tuesday actually look like, hour by hour?”	The answer you cannot get from the website, and the one you will reuse in every “why banking” for the next two years.
“What surprised you most in your first 90 days?”	Gets a real story instead of a recruiting line. People remember the person they told a real story to.
“What separates the analysts who get the return offer?”	A stage-three answer, delivered in stage two, by someone who watched it happen this summer.
“What’s a skill you wish you’d built before you started?”	Your technical prep list, written by the desk instead of by a guide.
“Is there anyone on your team I should be talking to?”	The only question that compounds. One yes turns a list of twenty into a list of forty, and the second name arrives warm.

Templates are scaffolding, not scripts. A message that reads like a template gets treated like one. The bracketed fields are the only part that matters. If you cannot fill one with something specific, you have not done the research yet.

Ask for time, not a job. Then ask for one name.

Take the 60-second quiz and get a personalized path from your current profile to the next seat on it.

TAKE THE QUIZ → wallstalpha.com/apply

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